

HREC template for an Information Sheet for research participants

(Please note that the final version of this form must contain the EPFL logo and the PI/lab header/footer).

INFORMATION SHEET FOR RESEARCH PARTICIPANTS

The information sheet is embedded in the online survey as the first element shown to the respondent.

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Name of the project: Climate Policy and Just Transition: A Comparative Study of Worker Support (JUST-CLIP)

This research project has been approved by the EPFL Human Research Ethics Committee (HREC No.....).

1. General Information and objectives

You are invited to take part in a research project that looks at your opinion regarding public policies aiming at mitigating climate change and decarbonizing key sectors of the economy. We also want to understand how support policies for affected workers (like financial aid or training) are viewed by those most impacted. Your answers will help us learn how these transitions can better protect jobs, communities, and democracy. This survey is run in France, Germany, Italy, Poland, and Spain. The research is led by Rens Chazottes at EPFL and Robin Huguenot-Noël at the Freie Universität Berlin. **We will never share your survey responses with your employer, colleagues, or any union representatives; your answers are completely confidential.**

2. Selection of Potential Participants

You have been invited because you work in a sector that may be affected by climate transition policies—such as manufacturing, the automobile industry, chemicals, or aviation. Participation is open to all workers currently employed in these industries, regardless of job type or union membership. We are carrying out this project in accordance with EU regulation and Swiss law and ethical research standards.

3. Procedure for Participants

If you choose to take part, you will be asked to complete an online questionnaire. It includes questions about your preferences between different policy proposals and how you feel about support measures, unions, and political views. The survey also asks a few general questions about your background (e.g., age group, job type, education).

- **Location:** Online, via a secure survey platform (Qualtrics)
- **Number of surveys:** 2
- **Duration:** Approximately 10 minutes

4. Benefits for Participants

Your responses will help researchers and policymakers design better support measures for workers like you during the energy transition. You will also be entered into a lottery to win a

€200 voucher as a thank you for your time.

5. Risks

By participating in this study, you will not be exposed to any particular risks. Some questions may touch on sensitive topics like job security or political opinions. You are free to skip any questions that make you uncomfortable or stop the survey at any time. All responses are anonymous and cannot be traced back to you.

6. Discoveries During the Project

For follow-up surveys and results dissemination, we will collect e-mail address, on a voluntary basis. If you prefer not to be informed of any potential findings and not participate in other survey waves, you are free to not provide your email address.

7. Participants' Rights

Your participation is voluntary. You may stop the survey at any time, for any reason, without needing to explain. This will not affect your job or any union membership in any way.

You also have the following rights:

- To withdraw your participation before submitting your answers.
- To be informed about the study and how we handle your data.
- To access, correct, or delete your personal data (if any is collected—see below).
- To object to the processing of personal data.
- To file a complaint with your local data protection authority if you believe your data is being misused.

8. Protection of Personal Data

This study collects your email address solely for the purpose of contacting winners of the lottery and for the participation to other survey waves. Your email will be stored separately from your survey responses, in a secure and protected folder. The data will be pseudonymised: this means your identifying information (such as your email) is replaced with a code and kept in a separate, secure file. As a result, your responses cannot be linked back to you personally, ensuring your anonymity is fully protected. All data will be stored securely on encrypted servers and only accessed by the research team. The anonymised data may be used in academic publications, but individuals or companies will never be identified. Once the study is completed, the data will be retained for a maximum of 5 years for academic purposes before being deleted or permanently anonymised.

The research project is conducted by

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